Part 4 — Recommendation and Next Opportunity

1. Recommendation: ITERATE

Decision: Proceed with a 30-day human-in-the-loop pilot, but do not deploy upGrad Radar as an independently trusted research system yet.

Rationale: The prototype successfully automates retrieval, AI extraction, evidence tracking, and competitor comparisons across eight programs. Initial issues involving international pricing, missing fields, and incorrect conflict detection were identified and substantially corrected.

The updated evaluation reports 34 passing automated tests, 61/61 scripted production acceptance checks, and 12/12 selected factual source checks. However, these results do not establish overall factual accuracy or verified time savings. Minor classification issues and source inconsistencies remain.

Leadership decision: The approach is promising enough to pilot, but wider adoption should depend on measurable reliability and productivity improvements.

2. Proposed 30-Day Pilot

Participants: Two competitive research analysts, one category/strategy manager, and one marketing stakeholder.

Scope: Great Learning, Simplilearn, and Emeritus benchmarked against upGrad across Data Science & Analytics and Executive / General Management.

Period	Plan
Week 1	Establish the manual research baseline, create a representative evaluation dataset, and resolve critical data-quality issues.
Week 2	Run AI-assisted research with analyst verification; record time, accuracy, missing fields, and corrections.
Week 3	Repeat research to evaluate consistency, source changes, and stakeholder usefulness.
Week 4	Compare automated and manual workflows; assess metrics and decide whether to expand, iterate, or stop.

Success criteria — consistent with Part 1

- **Primary metric:** ≥70% reduction in total time to produce a verified competitor brief, including human review.
- **Guardrail 1:** ≥95% field-level factual accuracy against a manually verified evaluation sample.
- **Guardrail 2:** 100% of material factual claims include traceable sources and verification statuses.

Key risks and mitigations: Regional redirects and incorrect program matches require market/identity checks; outdated prices and cohorts require review flags; extraction errors require source-linked evidence and human verification; retrieval/API failures require transparent error handling.

Scale decision: Expand only if the metrics are achieved and no critical accuracy failures remain.

3. Next Big Opportunity — AI Program Opportunity Radar

Concept: Extend competitor intelligence into evidence-backed identification of potential new education programs by combining competitor offerings with verified hiring trends and skills-demand signals.

Go-to-market sketch

- **Target users:** Initially upGrad's category strategy and program development teams; later, other education providers.
- **Value proposition:** Reduce the time needed to identify and evaluate promising course opportunities.
- **Distribution:** Begin with one internal category pilot, demonstrate useful opportunity briefs, then expand to additional teams and test external B2B adoption.
- **Pricing:** Internal pilot first; subsequently test monthly B2B subscriptions based on tracked categories and research volume.
- **Measurement:** Time to opportunity brief, proportion of opportunities accepted for further investigation, and program proposals informed by the research.

Conclusion: Competitive research automation is technically feasible. The immediate priority is proving trusted, repeatable business value before scaling into broader market-opportunity intelligence.